

Porirua Services Directory — Requirements

Version: 1.2 (draft)

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Prepared for: Porirua Locality / Te Wāhi Tiaki Tātou

Timeline: ~5–6 weeks total (MVP first, then iteration)

Budget: Phase 1 (MVP): ~50 hours / NZ\$5,000 · **Phase 2:** ~50 hours / NZ\$5,000 · **Total:** ~100 hours / NZ\$10,000

1. Purpose

Build a simple, trustworthy online directory so people in Porirua can **find help near them** — for food, housing, money worries, feeling unsafe, health, and other everyday needs.

The directory will bring together information that currently lives in two places:

- The **Porirua Community Connections Map** (local groups and services the community already knows and trusts)
- The **New Zealand Family Services Directory** (the government's national register of social services, filtered to Porirua)

The result should feel easy to use on a phone, use plain language, and stay accurate over **at least three years** with modest ongoing effort from the Porirua Locality team.

Delivery is **two phases**: a testable **MVP at half the budget** goes live first; the second half funds changes based on real user feedback and completes the admin and automation layer.

Design references: See [Human Services Directory Examples](#) and the [presentable slide deck](#) for comparable directories (Ask Izzy, 211, Family Services Directory, Kore Hiakai, ORServices, etc.).

1.1 Phased delivery (MVP first)

Phase	Budget	Goal
Phase 1 — MVP	~50 hrs / NZ\$5,000	Get a working directory into people's hands for testing
Phase 2 — Iteration	~50 hrs / NZ\$5,000	Modify based on feedback; add admin, automation, and polish

Why split? Real users (help-seekers and the Porirua Locality team) should shape categories, layout, and content before we invest in the full editing and sync infrastructure.

Phase 1 — MVP (in scope)

What people can test:

- **Standalone public website** — shareable URL, mobile-friendly
- **Need-based categories + search + map + crisis numbers**
- **Merged service listings** from Connections Map + Family Services Directory (Porirua-filtered)
- **Service cards** — name, description, phone, address, website where available
- *Community map* label for Connections Map entries

How data is managed in MVP (simplified):

- Connections Map continues via the **existing Google Sheet** (team already knows this)
- FSD imported via a **one-time script** (Porirua slice); re-run manually if needed before Phase 2 automation
- Merged dataset published as a **single data file** the public site reads
- Basic duplicate flagging at merge time (manual tidy-up acceptable for MVP)

MVP timeline: ~2–3 weeks to soft launch.

Phase 2 — Iteration (after testing)

Driven by MVP feedback, plus planned infrastructure:

- **Admin website** for review, edit, publish/hide
- **Weekly automated FSD sync** + review queue
- **Duplicate linking** in admin
- **Squarespace embed** on Porirua Locality site
- UX and content changes from testing (categories, labels, crisis strip, map behaviour)
- Editor guide, backups, and longevity hardening

Phase 2 timeline: ~2–3 weeks after MVP feedback is collected.

Deferred from MVP (confirmed for Phase 2 unless testing says otherwise)

- Password-protected admin area (Directus)
- Automatic weekly FSD refresh
- Squarespace embed
- Formal duplicate-management UI
- Full editor and technical runbooks

2. Who it is for

Primary users (public)

People in Porirua who need help and are not sure where to turn. They may be:

- Stressed, in a hurry, or on a limited mobile data plan
- Unfamiliar with service names or government categories
- Looking for something nearby they can call or visit today

The directory must **not require a login**, and must **not ask for personal details** to search.

Secondary users (behind the scenes)

Porirua Locality team members who keep listings accurate — reviewing imported data, fixing mistakes, and publishing or hiding services.

Community workers may share the link; the directory is **not** a referral or case-management system in this version.

3. What success looks like

Goal	How we will know
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People find help quickly	Clear categories ("I need food"), search, and a map of nearby services
Information is trustworthy	MVP: curated merge of Connections Map + reviewed FSD slice; Phase 2: publish/hide workflow
Local context is preserved	Community Connections Map organisations keep their local story and kaupapa where relevant
Real-world validation	MVP live within ~50 hrs; feedback collected before Phase 2 build
Low ongoing effort	Phase 2: government directory data refreshes automatically; team ~1–2 hrs/month on review
Long-lasting	Phase 2: stable tools, exportable data, documented handover
Fits the budget	MVP ≤ NZ\$5k; total project ≤ NZ\$10k

4. What the public will see

Sections 4.1–4.2 describe the **full target experience**. Phase 1 MVP delivers the core of this; Phase 2 adds embed and refinements from testing.

4.1 Landing experience

When someone opens the directory they should see, in this order:

1. **Emergency and crisis numbers** — always visible (e.g. 111, 105, 1737, Women's Refuge). These are not buried at the bottom of the page.
2. **"What do you need help with?"** — simple categories in everyday language, for example:
 - o Food / kai
 - o Housing / a place to stay
 - o Money help / budgeting
 - o Feeling unsafe / family violence support
 - o Support and counselling
 - o Health
 - o Legal advice
 - o Work and learning
 - o Everyday needs (clothes, showers, transport, etc.)
3. **Search** — type what they need; results filtered to Porirua-relevant services.
4. **Map** — show where services are; tap a marker for details.
5. **List of results** — cards below the map when a category or search is active.

People can start from a **need** ("I need food") or from the **map** ("what's near me"). They should not need to know which list a service came from.

4.2 Service listing (each result)

Each service should show, where available:

- Name
- Short description (plain language)
- Address or suburb

- Phone number (tap to call on mobile)
- Website link
- Opening hours (if known)

Optional small labels only when useful to the public, for example:

- *Community map* — curated local organisation from the Connections Map

Do **not** show internal labels like “government record” or database IDs.

4.3 Where it will live

	Phase 1 (MVP)	Phase 2
Standalone website	Yes — primary test URL	Yes — production URL
Squarespace embed	No — link out from Porirua Locality instead	Yes — lighter embed on existing site

Both phases use the same underlying data once Phase 2 is complete.

5. Data sources

Source	What it provides	How it stays current
Porirua Community Connections Map	Local organisations, kaupapa, initiatives, Assembly themes	Edited by Porirua Locality team in the admin area (initial import from existing spreadsheet / Google Sheet)
NZ Family Services Directory (FSD)	Broad national coverage of social services	MVP: one-time import, Porirua-filtered, manually reviewed before publish · Phase 2: automatic weekly import + review queue

Additional local lists may be added in future phases if a stable, maintainable source becomes available.

Porirua scope

Only services relevant to **people in Porirua** appear in the public directory. Rules for inclusion (e.g. based on suburb, region, or service area) will be agreed at the start of the project and documented.

Duplicate services

The same organisation may appear in both sources (e.g. Wesley Community Action in the Connections Map and the Family Services Directory). The system should:

- Detect likely duplicates automatically
- Let admins **link or hide** duplicates rather than show the same service twice
- Prefer the **richest local description** when merging (usually from the Connections Map)

6. Admin area (for the Porirua Locality team)

Phase 2. Not part of the MVP — in Phase 1 the team continues editing Connections Map orgs via the **Google Sheet**, and FSD updates are handled by re-running the import script.

A password-protected **admin website** (not public) where authorised team members can:

Task	Description
View all services	Search and filter the full list
Review new imports	See services flagged after a government directory sync; approve, edit, or hide
Edit a service	Fix name, description, phone, address, map pin, categories
Publish or hide	Control what appears on the public site
Handle duplicates	Mark one record as primary; hide or link others
Sync national data	Trigger “sync now” in addition to the automatic weekly run
Edit Connections Map entries	Update local organisations, themes, and initiatives

The admin area replaces long-term reliance on disconnected spreadsheets, though exports and backups remain available.

7. Maintenance and longevity

Ongoing effort

Activity	Phase	Who	How often
Connections Map edits	MVP + ongoing	Porirua Locality team	Via Google Sheet (MVP); admin UI (Phase 2)
FSD refresh	Phase 2	System	Weekly (automated)
FSD re-import	MVP only	Developer / team	Manual script run as needed
Review flagged changes	Phase 2	Porirua Locality team	~1–2 hours per month
System backups	Phase 2	Hosting	Daily (automated)
Gather MVP feedback	Between phases	Porirua Locality team	1–2 weeks after MVP launch

Target: after Phase 2, the directory remains useful for **at least three years** without a major rebuild.

Built to last

- **Your data is yours** — stored in a standard database that can be exported at any time (CSV/JSON).
 - **No dependency on short-lived startups** — see Appendix A for technical choices.
 - **Simple public site** — static pages that call a read-only data feed; minimal server maintenance.
 - **Documented handover** — short guide for editors plus a technical runbook for hosting and backups.
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8. Timeline

Phase 1 — MVP (~2–3 weeks, ~50 hours)

Week	Focus	Deliverables
1	Data + public shell	Porirua FSD filter rules; import Connections Map + FSD; merged dataset; categories + crisis strip
2	Public directory	Search, map, service cards; mobile testing; standalone URL live
3 (buffer)	Soft launch	Fix gaps; brief handover; start user testing

Between phases (~1–2 weeks, not in budget)

Collect feedback from help-seekers, Porirua Locality team, and community workers. Prioritise changes for Phase 2.

Phase 2 — Iteration (~2–3 weeks, ~50 hours)

Week	Focus	Deliverables
1	Feedback + admin	Implement priority UX/content changes; database + admin setup; review/publish workflow
2	Automation + embed	Weekly FSD sync; duplicate handling; Squarespace embed
3 (buffer)	Handover	Editor guide; backups; production launch

Total elapsed: roughly 5–8 weeks including the feedback window.

9. Budget

Phase	Hours	Cost
Phase 1 — MVP (testable public directory)	~50	NZ\$5,000
Phase 2 — Iteration (feedback + admin + automation)	~50	NZ\$5,000
Total	~100	NZ\$10,000

Ongoing hosting (from Phase 2): ~NZ\$25–60 per month (database + admin server + free static hosting). MVP can run on free static hosting with a merged data file — minimal cost.

Phase 1 — MVP includes

Public directory (categories, search, map, crisis strip), merged Connections Map + FSD data, standalone deployment, basic testing, soft launch.

Phase 2 — Iteration includes

Changes from user testing, admin area, automated weekly FSD sync, Squarespace embed, duplicate workflow, documentation, and production handover.

Not included in either phase

- Phone helpline or human navigator
 - Referral tracking ("did the person get help?")
 - Provider self-service login to edit their own listing
 - Installable phone app (PWA)
 - Usage analytics dashboard
 - Te Reo category labels (can be added later)
 - Additional third-party data sources beyond Connections Map and FSD
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10. Out of scope

Entire project

- User accounts for the public
- Collecting personal information from help-seekers
- Sending referrals to providers through the app
- Replacing 111 or national crisis helplines
- National coverage outside Porirua
- Real-time availability (e.g. "bed free tonight")
- Integrating referral-only tools that are not public directories (e.g. Police internal apps)

Phase 1 MVP specifically

- Admin website (Directus or equivalent)
 - Automatic weekly FSD sync
 - Squarespace embed
 - Formal duplicate-management UI
 - Full editor and technical runbooks
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11. Assumptions and dependencies

Item	Assumption
Porirua Locality team	1–5 people with admin login; ~1–2 hrs/month for review
FSD open data	Continues to be published on data.govt.nz
Connections Map	Existing Google Sheet / CSV remains the starting point for local organisations
Squarespace	Porirua Locality site retains Code block capability for embed
Branding	Reuse Porirua Locality colours and fonts where practical
Content	Team provides crisis numbers list and final category labels in plain language
MVP feedback	Porirua Locality team recruits testers and captures feedback between phases

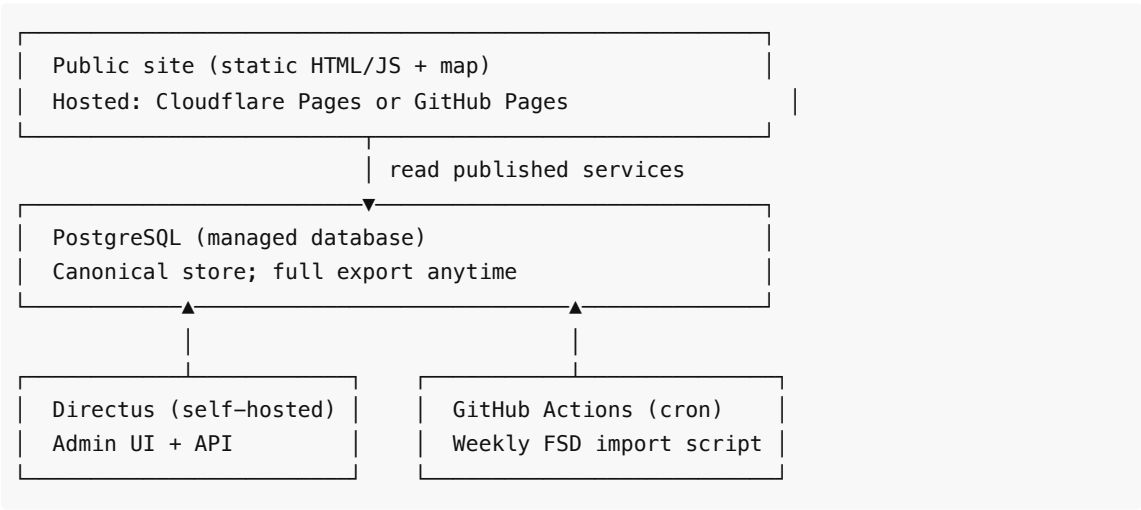
12. Approval

Role	Name	Date	Signature
Project sponsor			
Porirua Locality lead			

Appendices

Appendix A — Technical approach (for implementers)

Architecture summary



Component choices and rationale

Component	Choice	Why
Database	PostgreSQL (managed)	Industry standard; 30+ year track record; portable
Admin UI	Directus (self-hosted, open source)	Mature OSS admin; data stays in Postgres if Directus is ever replaced
Public frontend	Evolve existing vanilla JS + Leaflet map	Already built; minimal dependency churn
Map tiles	OpenStreetMap via Leaflet	Open, free, stable
FSD import	Python or Node script in repo + GitHub Actions	No proprietary scheduler; script is version-controlled
Public hosting	Cloudflare Pages	Static files only; no app server to patch
Admin hosting	Small VPS (Docker)	Directus + reverse proxy; ~NZ\$10–20/mo

Explicitly avoided: Firebase, Retool, Airtable-as-database, Supabase-specific lock-in, serverless-only backends tied to one vendor.

Alternative considered: [ORServices](#) — free ready-made directory package (public site + admin in one). Not selected for v1; see examples deck for comparison.

Data model (simplified)

Each **service** record includes:

- Identity: name, description, phone, email, website, address, map coordinates
- Categories: mapped to public need categories (food, housing, etc.)
- Status: draft | published | hidden
- Sources: which import contributed (Connections Map or FSD)
- Community metadata (optional): Assembly themes, org type, initiatives — for Connections Map entries
- Duplicate handling: link to primary record if merged

Records should be exportable in standard formats (CSV/JSON) so data can move if tools change.

FSD sync behaviour

1. Weekly cron fetches Family Services Directory CSV from data.govt.nz.
2. Filter to Wellington region / Porirua-relevant rules.
3. Compare with existing records (name + address fuzzy match).
4. New or changed rows → **review queue** (not auto-published).
5. Unchanged published rows → left as-is.
6. Admin can trigger manual sync.

Security

- Admin: password login; HTTPS only; small set of authorised users.
- Public API: read-only; published services only.
- No personal data stored about help-seekers.
- Daily automated database backups.

Exit strategies

If...	Then...
Directus is discontinued	Export Postgres; use pgAdmin or build simpler admin
GitHub Actions unavailable	Run same import script on any cron server
Static host changes	Move HTML/JS files to any web host
FSD format changes	Update import script only

Appendix B — Public need categories (draft)

Map Family Services Directory service types into these plain-language categories:

Category ID	Public label	Example services
food	Food / kai	Food banks, social supermarkets, community meals

housing	Housing / a place to stay	Emergency housing, tenancy advice, transitional housing
money	Money help	Budgeting, benefits advice, hardship grants
safety	Feeling unsafe	Family violence support, refuge, safety planning
support	Support and counselling	Mental health, addiction, grief, relationships
health	Health	GPs, clinics, community health, sexual health
legal	Legal advice	Community law, fines, tenancy disputes
work	Work and learning	Employment help, training, driver licensing
everyday	Everyday needs	Clothing, showers, transport, older person support

Final labels to be confirmed with Porirua Locality team (including Te Reo options in a future phase).

Appendix C — Hour breakdown

Phase 1 — MVP (~50 hours)

Work package	Hours
Discovery, Porirua filter rules, merged data model	4
FSD one-time import + Porirua filter	8
Merge Connections Map + FSD → published dataset	6
Public app: categories, search, map, crisis strip	22
Deploy standalone URL + MVP testing	4
Soft-launch handover + feedback plan	2
Contingency	4
Phase 1 total	50

Phase 2 — Iteration (~50 hours)

Work package	Hours
Synthesise user feedback + priority UX/content changes	6
Database setup, schema, backups	10
Admin setup (Directus) + review/publish workflow	14
FSD weekly automation + review queue	10
Squarespace embed	4
Duplicate handling in admin	4

Editor + technical documentation, production launch	2
Phase 2 total	50

	Hours
Grand total	100

Appendix D — Comparison with Ask Izzy (context)

[Ask Izzy](#) is Australia's mobile service finder — a useful reference, but a different scale:

	Ask Izzy	Porirua Services Directory (this project)
Coverage	National (~450k services)	Porirua-local
Data team	15+ full-time updaters	Porirua Locality + weekly FSD sync
Budget	Multi-year, multi-partner	~NZ\$10k total (NZ\$5k MVP + NZ\$5k iteration)
Strength	Breadth, zero-data telco deals	Local trust, community kaupapa, Connections Map

This project adopts Ask Izzy's **plain-language categories and mobile-first layout**, not its national infrastructure.

For a wider survey of comparable directories and toolkits, see [Human Services Directory Examples](#).

Appendix E — Related links

- [Porirua Community Connections Map](#)
- [Family Services Directory](#)
- [FSD open data \(data.govt.nz\)](#)
- [Ask Izzy](#)
- [ORServices \(free directory toolkit\)](#)
- [Examples overview \(this repo\)](#)
- [Examples slide deck \(this repo\)](#)

Changes in v1.2: Two-phase delivery — MVP at 50% budget (50 hrs / NZ\$5k) for user testing, then Phase 2 iteration (50 hrs / NZ\$5k) for admin, automation, and feedback-driven changes.

Changes in v1.1: Two data sources only (Connections Map + FSD). Removed AWHI spreadsheet and non-directory references. Added link to examples deck.